- 50% patients. with GDM develop type II later in life.
- After 6 wk. PP (Postprandial) serum glucose estimation to be done
- Children of GDM (Gestational Diabetes Mellitus) patients. ^ risk for obesity/ diabetes in childhood/adolescence

Pre-Conception Planning:

- Begin during reproductive years
- Maintain normal HbA1c 3-6 months before conception & during organogenesis (6-8weeks) –minimize risk of spontaneous AB & congenital anomalies.
- HbA1c level > 7: increased risk for congenital anomalies & miscarriage. (Normal HbA1c = 4-6 %.)
- Multidisciplinary team: nutritionist, endocrinologist, high risk OBG nurse.
- Educate patient.- managing diet, activity, insulin Excercise
- Daily food diary to assess compliance.

7.5 Normal Labour

Definition

Labour is the process resulting from uterine contraction leading to expulsion of products of conception from the uterine cavity through vagina.

Normal labour

Labour is called normal when it satisfies the following criteria

- Spontaneous onset of labour
- Starts at 38 – 40 weeks
- Vertex presentation
- Occipito-anterior position
- Labour is not unduly prolonged (average 12 hours)
- No complication to the mother and baby

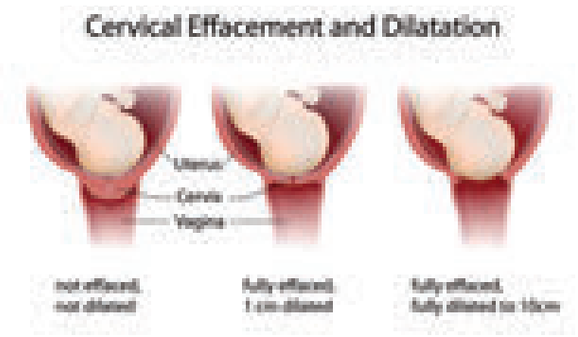
Causes of onset of labour

- The exact mechanisms are not known. The theories are,
- Biological – ageing of conceptus, cell degeneration, hypoxia.
- Mechanical – myometrial stretch, decidual cell stretch.
- Hormonal – prostaglandin release, oxytocin stimulation, fetal cortisol production and progesterone withdrawal.

Characteristics of uterine contraction

- Effective uterine contraction lasts for 30 – 90 secs create 20 – 30 mmHg of intrauterine pressure and occur every 2 – 4 minutes.
- The pain of contraction is throughout labour to be caused by one or more of the following
- Hypoxia of the contracted myometrium.
- Compression of nerve ganglia in the cervix and lower uterus by the tightly interlocking muscle bundles.
- Stretching of the cervix during dilatation.
- Stretching of the peritoneum overlying the uterus.

Changes in cervix



Effacement of the cervix: it is the shortening of the cervix. The cervix is pulled up and become a part of the uterine segment. Effacement is expressed as ranging from 0% (no reduction in length) to 100% palpable below the fetal presenting part.

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